

Try Your Hand at Owncloud Development

Owncloud is a free and open source file hosting software system. This article will introduce readers to it and also guide them on setting up an Owncloud developer environment.

Owncloud operates in a simple way to set up a cloud storage system (e.g., Dropbox) on your own website. Apart from being a cloud storage system like Dropbox, it allows people to make and share their own application software which has the capability of running their own Owncloud, including text editors, task lists and more. All of this makes it possible to get a little more out of Owncloud than just file syncing. Owncloud is an advanced version of Dropbox. Some of the applications which are currently available are files, documents, a photo gallery, a PDF viewer, music, mail, contacts, calendar, etc.

Frank Karlitschek developed Owncloud in 2010. His aim was to provide a free software replacement to proprietary storage service providers. This cloud storage has been integrated with the GNOME desktop. Integration of Owncloud with the Kolab groupware and collaboration project has been started recently. Groupware is an application software designed to help people involved in a common task to achieve goals, and Kolab is such a free and open source suite.

Owncloud makes it possible to specify a storage quota for users—the maximum space a user is allowed to use for files located in an individual's home storage. The storage space

available is good enough for all kinds of users. Administrators need to be aware, while setting a quota, that it is only applicable to actual files and not to application metadata. This means that when allocating a quota, they should make sure there is at least 10 per cent more space available for a given user. For a beginner, these things don't matter.

One of the great things about Owncloud is that it is cross-platform, and a number of applications support it. Much of this is achieved because it is open source and uses open standards or defines open application interfaces. Owncloud provides access to your data through a Web interface and provides a platform to easily view, synchronise and share across devices under one's control. Owncloud's open architecture is extensible via a simple but powerful application interface and plug-ins, and works with any storage.

Installation

Generally, Owncloud is considered an online storage source like the very common Google Drive. The benefit of Owncloud is that the server is on a location that you install it to and not on someone else's server.

This guide assumes that a LAMP stack is installed and

